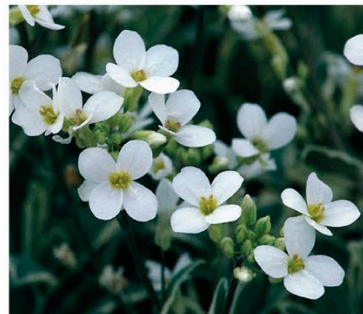




# Plants for rock gardens

Rock gardens have undergone a renaissance in recent years as gardeners rediscover the beauty of the diminutive sun-lovers they accommodate.

Rock and alpine plants are easy to care for, requiring very little annual maintenance once established. Create your rock garden in a sunny site, ideally on a naturally occurring slope. Excellent drainage is a must for all of these plants, so add plenty of grit to wet clay soils. Also include flowers for every season, starting in spring with bulbs, such as daffodils and tulips, together with perennial aubretia and rock cress. Continue the show with summer-flowering garden pink and rock rose, and end the year with heath and autumn crocus.



PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Arabis alpina* subsp. *caucasica*

**WALL ROCK CRESS** A mat-forming evergreen perennial with small, hairy gray-green leaves. It forms a carpet of white flowers from early spring to early summer. 'Variegata' (above) has white-edged leaves.

↑ 6in (15cm)

☞ Z4–7



PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Arenaria tetraquetra*

**SPANISH SANDWORT** A cushion-forming evergreen perennial with tiny gray-green leaves. Stemless, star-shaped white flowers appear in late spring. It makes a great partner for dwarf spring bulbs, such as grape hyacinth and daffodils.

↑ 1in (2.5cm) ↔ 6in (15cm) or more

☞ Z3–5



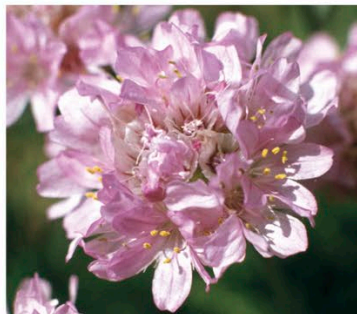
PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Anemone sylvestris*

**SNOWDROP WINDFLOWER** A dwarf perennial with divided midgreen leaves. Fragrant white flowers with yellow centers appear from spring to early summer. Plant in moist spot at the bottom of slope and protect from midday sun.

↑ 12in (30cm)

☞ Z3–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Armeria maritima*

**THRIFT** A clump-forming evergreen perennial that forms rounded tufts of grassy green leaves. Round heads of small white to pink flowers appear on slim stems in summer. Suitable as a "dot" plant in a rock garden and in alpine planters.

↑ 4in (10cm) ↔ 6in (15cm)

☞ Z4–8 (N)



PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Asperula arcadiensis*

**ARCADIAN WOODRUFF** A cushion-forming perennial with tiny, hairy gray leaves. Numerous pale pink flowers appear in early summer. Add well-rotted compost to the soil in the planting area to improve moisture retention in summer.

↑ 3in (8cm) ↔ 12in (30cm)

☞ Z5–7



PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Aubrieta deltoidea*

**AUBRETIA** An evergreen perennial with spreading stems of rounded gray-green leaves. In spring, it becomes covered with tiny blooms in shades of white, pink, red, and purple. Plant it at the edge of a bed where it will slowly spread.

↑ 2in (5cm) ↔ 24in (60cm)

☞ Z4–8



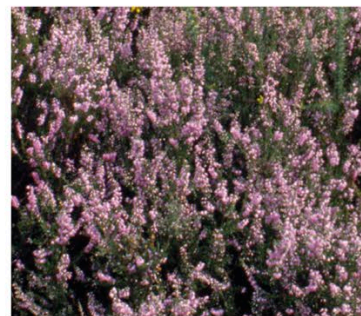
PERENNIAL SMALL

## *Calamintha nepeta*

**LESSER CALAMINT** This is an upright dwarf perennial that produces soft, aromatic, dark green basal leaves. From late summer to early fall, it bears spikes of tiny lilac-pink flowers that are attractive to bees.

↑ 18in (45cm) ↔ 30in (75cm)

☞ Z5–9



SHRUB SMALL

## *Calluna vulgaris*

**SCOTCH HEATHER** A bushy, low-growing evergreen shrub with linear gray-, yellow-, or bright green leaves and bell-shaped flowers in shades of pink, white, and purple from midsummer to late fall. Plant it in acidic soil.

↑ 24in (60cm) ↔ 18in (45cm)

☞ Z4–6